地政總署
Lands Department

AECOM

Simplified Data Specifications for

FUNCTIONAL AREA FSDT

Version 1.2
July 2025

Simplified Data Specifications for Functional Area (for Public Version) In English

Version: 1.2

July 2025

Foreword

To promote better sharing and accessibility of spatial data among the community of stakeholders in Hong Kong Special Administrative Region ("HKSAR"), the Government acknowledged its commitment to establishing Common Spatial Data Infrastructure ("CSDI"). The main objective is to provide Bureaux/Departments ("B/Ds") and public and private organisations with an information infrastructure to share spatial data, support various smart city applications, and support Smart City development.

In March 2017, the Development Bureau ("DEVB") commissioned a consultancy study on the overall strategy for implementing the CSDI. With its implementation, the CSDI would benefit the Government and society in the long run, with convenient and easy access to high-quality and up-to-date spatial information. The CSDI will help to:

- Facilitate and support the development of a dynamic and flexible geospatial environment that will provide standardised interfaces for accessing and disseminating common spatial information;
- Facilitate information sharing across different B/Ds and eventually other stakeholders;
- Encourage the adoption of common standards to ensure quality, compatibility and interoperability amongst different systems; and
- Make available a wide range of spatial data and analyses to enable potential applications.

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1. Introduction

1.1. General Overview

The Simplified Data Specifications for Functional Area ("the/this document") provide information about the datasets in the Functional Area Framework Spatial Data Theme ("FSDT").

1.2. Glossary and Definitions

This section provides a glossary of terms and definitions, listed alphabetically, as applicable to this document.

- **District Council District** ("DCD"): An area declared to be a District in or under the District Councils Ordinance[1].
- **District Council Geographical Constituency** ("DCGC")**:** means the boundaries of the District Council Ordinary Election, previously known as "District Council Constituency Areas ("DCCAs")", which took effect on 10 July 2023[2].
- **Subunit** ("SU") / **Street Block** ("SB"): Each Tertiary Planning Unit ("TPU") is sub-divided into SUs since end 2021. Before that, each TPU was sub-divided into a number of SB for urban areas and Village Clusters ("VC") for rural areas.
- **Tertiary Planning Unit**: The TPU is a geographic reference system demarcated by Planning Department ("PlanD") for the territory of Hong Kong[3].

[1]Cap. 547 District Councils Ordinance, 2023. https://www.elegislation.gov.hk/hk/cap547

[2]District Councils (Amendment) Ordinance, 2023. https://www.legco.gov.hk/yr2023/english/ord/2023ord019-e.pdf

[3] Final Report (Volume 2E) Specification and Explanatory Notes of TPU/SB CSU, 2004. https://www.devb.gov.hk/filemanager/en/content_384/frv2E.pdf

1.3. Acronyms and Abbreviations

This section lists the expanded description of all acronyms (words formed from the initial letters of a phrase) and abbreviations (the shortened form of a word or phrase) used in this document in alphabetical order.

Acronym/Abbreviation	Description
B/D	Bureau/Department
CSDI	Common Spatial Data Infrastructure
DCCA	District Council Constituency Area
DCD	District Council District
DCGC	District Council Geographical Constituency
DEVB	Development Bureau
EAC	Electoral Affairs Commission
FSDT	Framework Spatial Data Theme
HAD	Home Affairs Department
HKSAR	Hong Kong Special Administrative Region
LandsD	Lands Department
OGCIO	Office of the Government Chief Information Officer
PlanD	Planning Department
PPU	Primary Planning Unit
SB	Street Block
SI	International System of Units
SPU	Secondary Planning Unit
SU	Subunit
the/this document	Simplified Data Specifications for Functional Area
TPU	Tertiary Planning Unit
URL	Uniform Resource Locator
VC	Village Cluster

2. Framework Spatial Data Definitions

2.1. Overview

Functional Area is defined as the subdivisions of land and/or water into units according to some intended purposes, including but not limited to the geographical extent of administrative, electoral, planning, and service delivery at the district level.

2.2. Scope & Definitions

This document covers the following sub-themes:

- **District:** District is delineated to achieve more effective co-ordination of the provision of services and facilities at the district level.
- **Planning Area:** Planning Area includes areas designated for particular land uses, preservation or other management treatment or controls. The designation of planning area usually results from some spatial planning processes that may be codified in law, in the case of boundaries with legal and regulatory standing.
- **Electoral Area:** A discrete, geographically bounded subdivision of a larger state created to provide its population with representation in the larger state's legislative body, where electors are entitled to vote in contests that are specific to that area. This can be the areas of statistical enumerations or the geographical basis for summarising information collected.

3. Framework Spatial Data Content & Structure

3.1. Datasets under Sub-themes

There are three sub-themes within the Functional Area FSDT, namely District, Planning Area and Electoral Area.

District sub-theme covers the following dataset(s):

- District Boundary: This dataset provides Geo-referenced data of District Boundary including district names in Chinese and English as well as boundary coordinates (longitudes and latitudes).

Planning Area sub-theme covers the following dataset(s):

- Boundaries of Tertiary Planning Units & Subunits [Year]*: For town planning purpose, the whole territory of Hong Kong is divided into TPUs and updated every five years for Population Census and Population By-census. On one hand, these TPUs are sub-divided into SUs. On the other hand, these TPUs are aggregated under 52 Secondary Planning Units ("SPUs") at the next higher level. The SPUs are further grouped under nine Primary Planning Units ("PPUs") at the highest level. Each of the TPU is identified by a unique three-digit number. The first digit of a TPU number identifies the PPU code while the first and second digits together correspond to the SPU code. The data structure is fixed but geometry will be updated as needed.

  * The dataset has been renamed from "Boundaries of Tertiary Planning Units & Street Blocks / Village Clusters" to "Boundaries of Tertiary Planning Units & Subunits" since 2021, as well as the corresponding field has been renamed from "SB_VC" to "Subunit."

Electoral Area sub-theme covers the following dataset(s):

- District Council Geographical Constituency Boundaries of the [Year] District Council Ordinary Election*: The datasets delineate the boundaries of the corresponding [Year] District Council Ordinary Election. The delineation exercise of the corresponding [Year] follows the relevant ordinances and procedures. The maps and descriptions of the delineation of DCGCs are available at the Electoral Affairs Commission ("EAC")'s website (www.eac.hk).

  * The dataset was previously known as "[Year] District Council Ordinary Election Constituency Boundaries" prior to July 2023.

- Existing Village/ Market Town Boundaries for Rural Representative Election [Year]: Geo-referenced data of Existing Village/ Market Town Boundaries for Rural Representative Election. Such type of data was first launched in December 2022 and the new data will be released every four years.

3.2. Physical Data Model

This section describes the physical data model for each sub-theme within the Functional Area FSDT.

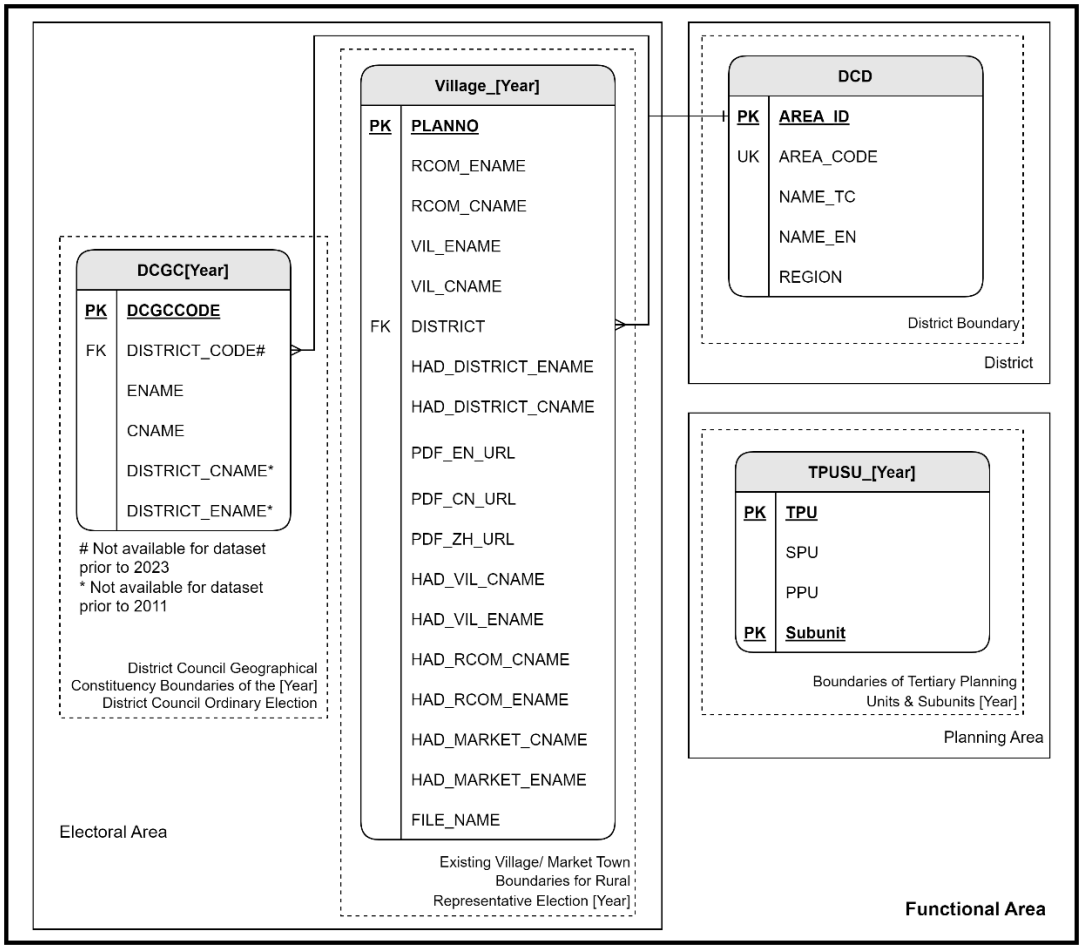

Figure 3-1 Physical Data Model of Functional Area FSDT

3.3. Entity Description

This section provides a detailed description of each physical entity illustrated in the physical data model in Section 3.2.

3.3.1. District – District Boundary

3.3.1.1. DCD

Entity type: Feature Layer

Field Name (Alias Name, optional)	Data Type	Description	Allow Null Value (Y/N)
AREA_ID	String, 1	District Council Identifier	Y
AREA_CODE	String, 5	District Council Code	Y
NAME_TC	String, 100	District Council Name (Traditional Chinese)	Y
NAME_EN	String, 100	District Council Name (English)	Y
REGION	String, 100	Region of the District Code (i.e. HK, KLN or NT)	Y

3.3.2. Planning Area - Boundaries of Tertiary Planning Units & Subunits [Year]

3.3.2.1. TPUSU_[Year]

Entity type: Feature Layer

Field Name (Alias Name, optional)	Data Type	Description	Allow Null Value (Y/N)
PPU	Short, 1	Primary Planning Unit	N
SPU	Short, 2	Secondary Planning Unit	N
TPU	Short, 3	Tertiary Planning Unit	N
Subunit^	Short, 2	Subunit	N

^ For TPUSBVC_[Year] dataset prior to 2021, the field name is SB_VC.

3.3.3. Electoral Area - District Council Geographical Constituency Boundaries of the [Year] District Council Ordinary Election

3.3.3.1. DCGC[Year]

Entity type: Feature Layer

Field Name (Alias Name, optional)	Data Type	Description	Allow Null Value (Y/N)
DCGCCODE^	String, 3	District Council Geographical Constituency Code	Y
DISTRICT_CODE#	String, 1	District Council Identifier	Y
ENAME	String, 40	District Council Geographical Constituency Area Name (English)	Y
CNAME	String, 40	District Council Geographical Constituency Area Name (Traditional Chinese)	Y
DISTRICT_CNAME*%	String, 40	District Council Name (Traditional Chinese)	Y
DISTRICT_ENAME*%	String, 40	District Council Name (English)	Y

^ For DCCA[Year] dataset prior to July 2023, the field name is CACODE.

Not available for datasets prior to 2023

* Not available for datasets prior to 2011

% For DCCA[Year] dataset prior to July 2023, the field name is DISTRICT_T and DISTRICT_E.

3.3.4. Electoral Area - Existing Village/ Market Town Boundaries for Rural Representative Election [Year]

3.3.4.1. Village_[Year]

Entity type: Feature Layer

Field Name (Alias Name, optional)	Data Type	Description	Allow Null Value (Y/N)
PLANNO	String, 20	Map on which the area of the Village/ Market Town is delineated	N
RCOM_ENAME	String, 30	Rural Committee Name (English)	N
RCOM_CNAME	String, 30	Rural Committee Name (Traditional Chinese)	N
VIL_ENAME	String, 80	Existing Village or Market Town Name (English)	N
VIL_CNAME	String, 80	Existing Village or Market Town Name (Traditional Chinese)	N

Field Name (Alias Name, optional)	Data Type	Description	Allow Null Value (Y/N)
DISTRICT	String, 1	District Council Identifier	N
HAD_DISTRICT_ENAME	String, 30	District Council Name (English)	N
HAD_DISTRICT_CNAME	String, 30	District Council Name (Traditional Chinese)	N
PDF_EN_URL	String, 100	URL Link for the Existing Village Map or Market Town Map in pdf (English)	N
PDF_CN_URL	String, 100	URL Link for the Existing Village Map or Market Town Map in pdf (Simplified Chinese)	N
PDF_ZH_URL	String, 100	URL Link for the Existing Village Map or Market Town Map in pdf (Traditional Chinese)	N
HAD_RCOM_CNAME	String, 30	Rural Committee Name (Traditional Chinese)	N
HAD_RCOM_ENAME	String, 30	Rural Committee Name (English)	N
HAD_VIL_CNAME	String, 80	Existing Village Name (Traditional Chinese)	Y
HAD_VIL_ENAME	String, 80	Existing Village Name (English)	Y
HAD_MARKET_CNAME	String, 80	Market Town Name (Traditional Chinese)	Y
HAD_MARKET_ENAME	String, 80	Market Town Name (English)	Y
FILE_NAME	String, 50	File Name	N

3.4. Unique Identifiers

The following table describes the unique identifier of each entity in the Functional Area FSDT.

Data Layer	Unique Identifier	Description
DCD	AREA_ID	A unique identifier based on District Councils Ordinance (Cap. 547), Schedule 1, Part II, Declaration of Districts[4], e.g. "A" for Central and Western district.
	AREA_CODE	An alternate identifier published by Office of the Government Chief Information Officer ("OGCIO") listed in the English District Council Code Interoperability Framework for e-Government[5], e.g. "CW" for Central and Western district.
TPUSU_[Year]	TPU, Subunit	TPU and Subunit together form a composite identifier maintained by PlanD, for example, TPU "265" with Subunit "9" is unique in the data layer.
DCGC[Year]	DCGCCODE	A unique identifier maintained by EAC which consists of two segments, for example, "A2". The following describes the content of each segment: • "A": AREA_ID in DCD entity, "A" for Central and Western District • "2": Sub-area identifier.
Village_[Year]	PLANNO	A unique identifier maintained by Home Affairs Department ("HAD") with reference to village boundary plans based on Rural Representative Election Ordinance (Cap. 576), Schedule 1, Column 2[6]. It consists of five segments, for example, "VEB/2002/M/ST-15A". The following describes the content of each segment: • "VEB/2002": Constant prefix • "M": AREA_ID in DCD entity, "M" for Yuen Long District • "ST": Short form of Rural Committee Name, "ST" for San Tin • "15": Sequential number for each village • "A": Optional character if village could not be presented in one map.

[4] District Councils Ordinance (Cap. 547), Schedule 1, Part II, Declaration of Districts: https://www.elegislation.gov.hk/hk/cap547!en?xpid=ID_1438403414491_002&INDEX_CS=N

[5] OGCIO English District Council Code in Interoperability Framework for E-Government https://www.ogcio.gov.hk/en/our_work/infrastructure/e_government/if/code_lists/district_council_code_eng/index.html

[6] Rural Representative Election Ordinance (Cap. 576), Schedule 1, Column 2: https://www.elegislation.gov.hk/hk/cap576!en?xpid=ID_1438403480729_004&INDEX_CS=N

3.5. Geographical Coverage

The dataset(s) specified in this document covers the entire territories of HKSAR.

3.6. Units of Measurement

The units of measurement used in all datasets under Functional Area FSDT refer to the International System of Units ("SI").

3.7. Spatial Resolution/Scale

The spatial resolution(s) or scale(s) of the dataset(s) specified in this document is/are:

- District Boundary: The dataset is maintained at a scale of 1:1,000 to show the approximate locations of the Districts.
- Boundaries of Tertiary Planning Units & Subunits: The dataset is maintained at a scale of 1:1,000 to show the approximate locations of the Planning Area.
- District Council Geographical Constituency Boundaries of the [Year] District Council Ordinary Election: The dataset is maintained at a scale of 1:1,000 to show the approximate locations of the Electoral Area.
- Existing Village/ Market Town Boundaries for Rural Representative Election [Year]: The dataset is maintained at a scale of 1:1,000 to show the approximate locations of the Electoral Area.

3.8. Spatial Representation Type

The spatial representation type(s) of the dataset(s) specified in this document is/are:

- All datasets are represented as polygons to represent the geographical location of the entity.

3.9. Spatial Reference System

The spatial data covered in this document are geo-referenced or projected to one of the Coordinate Reference Systems as specified in the Simplified Data Specifications for Coordinate Reference System of the CSDI.

3.10. Relationships and Dependencies with Other FSDTs

The District Boundary and District Council Geographical Constituency Boundaries of the [Year] District Council Ordinary Election, and the Boundaries of Tertiary Planning Units & Subunits [Year] datasets under this FSDT are necessary for preparing census datasets in the Population Distribution FSDT. The TPUSU_[Year] entity would be used to prepare the geographical boundaries for census data, including entities of LTPUG_[Year], STPUG_[Year], LSBG_[Year] and SSBG_[Year] (LSBG and SSBG have been renamed as LSUG and SSUG since 2021 Population Census) for each census. The DCD entity would be used to derive district boundaries, and the DCGC[Year] entity* would also be used to drive DCGC boundaries used for each census.

The District sub-theme contains the District Boundary dataset. The field District Council District Code (AREA_CODE, a 2-3 letter code) in the DCD entity can be associated with:

- the DISTRICT field in the GEO_PLACE_NAME entity of the Place Name dataset from the Geographic Name FSDT Geographic Name sub-theme;
- the DISTRICTCODE field in the ADDRESS2DID entity from the Address FSDT; and
- the DISTRICTCODE field in the DISTRICT entity from the Address FSDT.

The District sub-theme contains the District Boundary dataset. The field District Council District Class (AREA_ID, a 1-character letter code) in the DCD entity can be associated with Population Distribution FSDT:

- DC_CLASS field in DC[Year] entity in [Year] Population Statistics (By District Council District) dataset from the Population Distribution FSDT Census Data sub-theme; and
- DC_CLASS field in DCCA[Year] or DCGC_[Year] entity in [Year] Population Statistics (By District Council Constituency Area) from the Population Distribution FSDT Census Data sub-theme.

The Electoral Area sub-theme contains the "District Council Geographical Constituency Boundaries of the [Year] District Council Ordinary Election" dataset. The field "DCGCCODE" in the "DCGC[Year]" entity* can be associated with:

- The "DCCA_CLASS" field in the "DCCA[Year]" or "DCGC_[Year]" entity in "[Year] Population Statistics (By District Council Constituency Area)" from the Population Distribution FSDT Census Data sub-theme.

*The relationship was based on the previous dataset "DCCA[Year]" with "CACODE". The DCGC has been adopted instead of DCCA since July 2023.

The English version shall prevail in case of any discrepancy or inconsistency between the English version and its Chinese translation.